

Treasury Policy Analyst — Persona Brief

Purpose: Every visual, design and slide decision should serve this persona. If a choice cannot be justified by asking 'does this help Michael write a better policy brief?', reconsider it.

Primary Persona

Name	Michael Chen
Age	41
Role	Senior Economic Adviser, Australian Treasury — Wages Policy Division
Reports to	Assistant Secretary, Labour Market Analysis Branch
Goal	Build the evidence base that decision-makers act on.

What Michael Knows vs. What Our Dashboard Must Show

Michael already knows	Our dashboard must show him
Headline CPI from the most recent ABS release	Which specific CPI categories are driving the gap most severely in 2024–2025
That nominal wages have been rising	Which states have the worst real wage outcomes relative to the national average
That a real wage squeeze occurred post-2022	What specific wage growth rate restores positive real outcomes under current CPI
The general shape of the WPI trend	How WPI and CPI have evolved quarter by quarter at granular level across the full 9-quarter dataset

Engagement Signals

What makes Michael disengage immediately	What makes Michael lean in
Unlabelled axes or missing units	ABS table references named explicitly (WPI Table 1, CPI Table 18)
Tooltips that repeat what is already visible	The engineered metric (real_wage_growth = WPI minus CPI) explained in one line with formula
Narrative that states the obvious	A counterintuitive state-level finding he has not seen in a departmental brief
Unrounded floating point numbers	The what-if slider framed as a policy instrument, not a toy
Claims not traceable to a named ABS source	Honest acknowledgment of data limitations (e.g. QoQ vs seasonally adjusted)

Three User Stories

Story 1 — The Gap

As Michael, I want to see wage growth and CPI on a single timeline so I can quantify the real wage gap per quarter and assess whether conditions are improving heading into the current fiscal year.

Acceptance Criteria: Dual-line chart with filled gap area (green/red at zero), tooltip showing WPI, CPI and real_wage_growth on hover. Narrative text updates on quarter selection.

Definition of Done: Updates dynamically on quarter filter. All values rounded to one decimal place. Narrative sentence approved by Orator.

Story 2 — The Culprits

As Michael, I want CPI broken down by expenditure category so I can identify which cost pressures (housing, food, transport) justify targeted sectoral policy recommendations.

Acceptance Criteria: Categories displayed with cumulative QoQ figures. Above-average contributors visually distinguished. Narrative callout references headline CPI for comparison.

Definition of Done: All figures verified against ABS CPI Table 18. Narrative callout reviewed by Orator.

Story 3 — The Scenario

As Michael, I want to model hypothetical wage growth rates so I can calculate the exact threshold required to restore positive real outcomes and present it as a quantified recommendation.

Acceptance Criteria: Dual sliders (wage growth + inflation) update projection overlay in real time. Plain-English verdict updates dynamically. Recovery target field populated.

Definition of Done: Calculations verified against ABS baseline. Verdict strings approved by Orator for policy language.